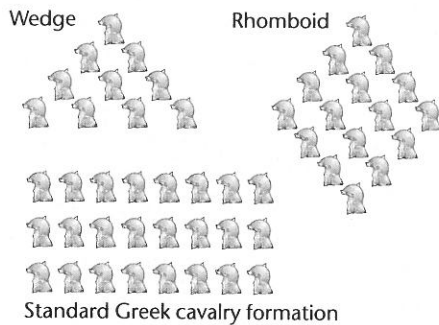
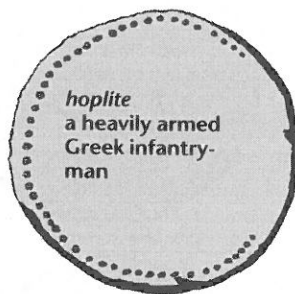




**The wedge or rhomboid formation used by the Companion Cavalry. What advantages do the wedge and the rhomboid have over a standard cavalry formation? Consider what happens if a quick change of direction is needed. Which formations could fit through gaps in lines of infantry the easiest?**



Granicus, Issus and Gaugamela. They were used as shock troops to charge through enemy units at a point of weakness.

#### The prodromoi

These lightly armoured Macedonian cavalry carried similar weapons to the hetairoi, and were usually used as scouts. They fought at the Battle of Granicus alongside the hetairoi.

#### Other cavalry types

Alexander also used cavalry from other areas, for example the Paeonian, Thessalian and Thracian cavalry. Their armour and weapons varied depending on where they came from but most relied on javelins and swords. Alexander used these troops to harass enemy cavalry or to outflank or get around the sides of the enemy army and to then chase it when it ran. Eventually he used Persian, Indian,

Sakae and even Dahae horse archers to reinforce and expand his army as he marched through Persia. Usually, however, he relied on quality rather than quantity—another sign of a good leader.

#### The engineer (or siege) corps

Philip had been the first commander in Greece to employ a full-time professional siege corps to capture enemy cities. He revolutionised siege warfare: after Philip it was no longer necessary to wait for a city to be starved out and surrender. This sped up campaigns that required the capture of fortified strong points, and came in handy for Alexander at the sieges of Miletus, Halicarnassus, Tyre, Gaza and Aornus. The siege corps was even used at the battle of the Hydaspes (326BC) to confuse the Indian king Porus.

#### Question the sources

Diodorus Siculus gives us an army list for the Persian expedition. Read this extract and answer the questions that follow.

[After visiting Troy] Alexander made an accurate count of the forces he commanded. He found their numbers to be as follows. Of infantry, there were 12 000 Macedonians, 7000 allies, 5000 mercenaries, all under Parmenio's command. 7000 Odrysians, Triballians, and Illyrians accompanied him, together with 1000 Agrianians and archers, so that the total of infantry was 32 000. Of cavalry, there were 1800 Macedonians commanded by Philotas, son of Parmenio, 1800 Thessalians, commanded by Callas, son of Harpalus, 600 from the Greek allies led by Erigyius, and 900 Thracians, Scouts and Paeonians under Cassander, making a total of 4500 cavalry [actually 5100]. This was the number of men who crossed to Asia with Alexander. The soldiers left behind in Europe, under the command of Antipater, totalled 12 000 infantry, and 1500 cavalry.

DIODORUS SICULUS, 17.17

- List the various troops and their numbers mentioned by Diodorus.
- Using the information presented earlier, work out what weaponry each of these various nationalities used.
- What nationality, do you think, would the troops left with Antipater have been? Why?
- Where might Diodorus have got this information?
- What problems might exist with this information (apart from the maths!)? Can we trust it?
- Historians gather evidence from historical sources. They need to be able to tell whether or not a source is reliable and telling the truth about the past. In order to do this they need to know something about the sources. Go to a library and find out who Diodorus Siculus was, and when and where he wrote. Find out about Plutarch and Arrian while you are there.